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Feature-testing recommendations for C++

[1] Preface

[1] This revision of this document contains STUBS for sections expected to be filled in later.

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[1] Introduction

[1] At the September 2013 (Chicago) meeting of WG21, there was a five-way poll of all of the C++ experts in attendance – approximately 80 – concerning their support for the approach described herein for feature-testing in C++. The results of the poll:

Strongly favor	Favor	Neutral	Oppose	Strongly oppose
lots	lots	1	0	0

[2] This document was subsequently designated WG21's SD-6 (sixth standing document), which will continue to be maintained by SG10.

[2] Explanation and rationale for the approach

[2.1] Problem statement

[1] The pace of innovation in the standardization of C++ makes long-term stability of implementations unlikely. Features are added to the language because programmers want to use those features. Features are added to (the working draft of) the standard as the features become well-specified. In many cases a feature is added to an implementation well before or well after the standard officially introducing it is approved.

[2] This process makes it difficult for programmers who want to use a feature to know whether it is available in any given implementation. Implementations rarely leap from one formal revision of the standard directly to the next; the implementation process generally proceeds by smaller steps. As a result, testing for a specific revision of the standard (e.g. by examining the

value of the `__cplusplus` macro) often gives the wrong answer. Implementers generally don't want to appear to be claiming full conformance to a standard revision until all of its features are implemented. That leaves programmers with no portable way to determine which features are actually available to them.

[3] It is often possible for a program to determine, in a manner specific to a single implementation, what features are supported by that implementation; but the means are often poorly documented and ad hoc, and sometimes complex – especially when the availability of a feature is controlled by an invocation option. To make this determination for a variety of implementations in a single source base is complex and error-prone.

[2.2] Status quo

[1] Here is some code that attempts to determine whether rvalue references are available in the implementation in use:

```
#ifndef __USE_RVALUE_REFERENCES
    #if (__GNUC__ > 4 || __GNUC__ == 4 && __GNUC_MINOR__ >= 3) || \
        _MSC_VER >= 1600
        #if __EDG_VERSION__ > 0
            #define __USE_RVALUE_REFERENCES (__EDG_VERSION__ >= 410)
        #else
            #define __USE_RVALUE_REFERENCES 1
        #endif
    #elif __clang__
        #define __USE_RVALUE_REFERENCES __has_feature(cxx_rvalue_references)
    #else
        #define __USE_RVALUE_REFERENCES 0
    #endif
#endif
```

[2] First, the GNU and Microsoft version numbers are checked to see if they are high enough. But then a check is made of the EDG version number, since that front end also has compatibility modes for both those compilers, and defines macros indicating (claimed) compatibility with them. If the feature wasn't implemented in the indicated EDG version, it is assumed that the feature is not available – even though it is possible for a customer of EDG to implement a feature before EDG does.

[3] Fortunately Clang has ways to test specifically for the presence of specific features. But unfortunately, the function-call-like syntax used for such tests won't work with a standard preprocessor, so this fine new feature winds up adding its own flavor of complexity to the mix.

[4] Also note that this code is only the beginning of a real-world solution. A complete solution would need to take into account more compilers, and also command-line option settings specific to various compilers.

[2.3] Characteristics of the proposed solution

[1] To preserve implementers' freedom to add features in the order that makes the most sense for themselves and their customers, implementers should indicate the availability of each separate feature by adding a definition of a macro with the name corresponding to that feature.

[2] **Important note:** By recommending the use of these macros, WG21 is **not** making any feature optional; the absence of a definition for the relevant feature-test macro does not make an implementation that lacks a feature conform to a standard that requires the feature. However, if implementers and programmers follow these recommendations, portability of code between real-world implementations should be improved.

[3] To a first approximation, a feature is identified by the WG21 paper in which it is specified, and by which it is introduced into the working draft of the standard. Not every paper introduces a new feature worth a feature-test macro, but every paper that is not just a collection of issue resolutions is considered a candidate; exceptions are explicitly justified.

[4] For C++14, the feature-test macro name generally consists of some combination of words from the title of the paper. In the future, it is hoped that every paper will include its own recommendations concerning feature-test macro names.

[5] The value specified for a feature-test macro is based on the year and month in which the feature is voted into the working draft. In a case where a feature is subsequently changed in a significant way, but arguably remains the same feature, the value of the macro is changed to indicate the “revision level” of the specification of the feature. However, in most cases it is expected that the presence of a feature can be determined by the presence of any non-zero macro value; for example:

```
#if __cpp_binary_literals
int const packed_zero_to_three = 0b00011011;
#else
int const packed_zero_to_three = 0x1B;
#endif
```

[6] To avoid the user's namespace, names of macros for language features are prefixed by “`__cpp_`”; for library features, by “`__cpp_lib_`”. A library feature that doesn't introduce a new header is expected to be defined by the header(s) that implement the feature.

[3] Recommendations

[3.1] Introduction

[1] For the sake of improved portability between partial implementations of various C++ standards, WG21 (the ISO technical committee for the C++ programming language) recommends that implementers and programmers follow the guidelines in this document concerning feature-test macros.

[2] Implementers who provide a new standard feature should define a macro with the recommended name and value, in the same circumstances under which the feature is available (for example, taking into account relevant command-line options), to indicate the presence of support for that feature.

[3] Programmers who wish to determine whether a feature is available in an implementation should base that determination on the state of the macro with the recommended name. (The absence of a tested feature may result in a program with decreased functionality, or the relevant functionality may be provided in a different way. A program that strictly depends on support for a feature can just try to use the feature unconditionally; presumably, on an implementation lacking necessary support, translation will fail. Therefore, if the most useful purpose for a feature-test macro would be to control the inclusion of a `#error` directive if the feature is unavailable, that is considered inadequate justification for the macro. Note that the usefulness of a test macro for a feature is completely independent of the usefulness of the feature itself.)

[3.2] Testing for the presence of a header: `__has_include`

[1] It is impossible for a C++ program to directly, reliably and portably determine whether or not a library header is available for inclusion. Conditionally including a header requires the use of a configuration macro, whose setting can be determined by a configuration-test process at build time (reliable, but less portable), or by some other means (often not reliable or portable).

[2] To solve this general problem, WG21 recommends that implementers provide, and programmers use, the `__has_include` feature.

[3.2.1] Syntax

h-preprocessing-token:

any *preprocessing-token* other than >

h-pp-tokens:

h-preprocessing-token

h-pp-tokens h-preprocessing-token

has-include-expression:

`__has_include ( header-name )`

`__has_include ( string-literal )`

`__has_include ( < h-pp-tokens > )`

[3.2.2] Semantics

[1] In the first form of the *has-include-expression*, the parenthesized *header-name* token is not subject to macro expansion. The second and third forms are considered only if the first form does not match, and the preprocessing tokens are processed just as in normal text.

[2] A *has-include-expression* shall appear only in the controlling constant expression of a `#if` or `#elif` directive ([cpp.cond] 16.1). Prior to the evaluation of such an expression, the source file identified by the parenthesized preprocessing token sequence in each contained *has-include-expression* is searched for as if that preprocessing token sequence were the *pp-tokens* in a `#include` directive, except that no further macro expansion is performed. If such a directive would not satisfy the syntactic requirements of a `#include` directive, the program is ill-formed. The *has-include-expression* is replaced by the *pp-number* 1 if the search for the source file succeeds, and by the *pp-number* 0 if the search fails.

[3] The `#ifdef` and `#ifndef` directives, and the `defined` conditional inclusion operator, shall treat `__has_include` as if it were the name of a defined macro. The identifier `__has_include` shall not appear in any context not mentioned in this section.

[3.2.3] Example

[1] This demonstrates a way to use a library optional facility only if it is available.

```
#ifndef __has_include
# if __has_include(<optional>)
#   include <optional>
#   define have_optional 1
# elif __has_include(<experimental/optional>)
#   include <experimental/optional>
#   define have_optional 1
#   define experimental_optional
# else
#   define have_optional 0
# endif
#endif
```

[3.3] Testing for the presence of an attribute: `__has_cpp_attribute`

[1] A C++ program cannot directly, reliably, and portably determine whether or not a standard or vendor-specific attribute is available for use. Testing for attribute support generally requires complex macro logic, as illustrated above for language features in general.

[2] To solve this general problem, WG21 recommends that implementers provide, and programmers use, the `__has_cpp_attribute` feature.

[3.3.1] Syntax

```
has-attribute-expression:
    __has_cpp_attribute ( attribute-token )
```

[3.3.2] Semantics

- [1] A *has-attribute-expression* shall appear only in the controlling constant expression of a `#if` or `#elif` directive ([cpp.cond] 16.1). The *has-attribute-expression* is replaced by a non-zero pp-number if the implementation supports an attribute with the specified name, and by the pp-number 0 otherwise.
- [2] For a standard attribute, the value of the `__has_cpp_attribute` macro is based on the year and month in which the attribute was voted into the working draft. In the case where the attribute is vendor-specific, the value is implementation-defined. However, in most cases it is expected that the availability of an attribute can be detected by any non-zero result.
- [3] The `#ifdef` and `#ifndef` directives, and the `defined` conditional inclusion operator, shall treat `__has_cpp_attribute` as if it were the name of a defined macro. The identifier `__has_cpp_attribute` shall not appear in any context not mentioned in this section.

[3.3.3] Example

[1] This demonstrates a way to use the attribute `[[deprecated]]` only if it is available.

```
#ifndef __has_cpp_attribute
# if __has_cpp_attribute(deprecated)
#   define ATTR_DEPRECATED(msg) [[deprecated(msg)]]
# else
#   define ATTR_DEPRECATED(msg)
# endif
#endif
```

[3.4] C++17 features

- [1] The following table itemizes all the changes that were made to the working draft for C++17 as specified in a WG21 technical document. (Changes that were made as specified in a core or library issue are not generally included.)
- [2] The table is sorted by the section of the standard primarily affected. The “Doc. No.” column links to the paper itself on the committee web site. The “Macro Name” column links to the relevant portion of the “Detailed explanation and rationale” section of this document. When the recommendation is to change the value of a macro previously recommended to be defined, the “Value” column links to the table entry for the previous recommendation.
- [3] For library features, the “Header” column identifies the header that is expected to define the macro, although the macro may also be predefined. For language features, the macro must be predefined.

Doc. No.	Title	Primary Section	Macro Name	Value	Header
N4086	Removing trigraphs??!	2.4	none		
N4267	Adding u8 character literals	2.14	none		
N4261	Proposed resolution for Core Issue 330: Qualification conversions and pointers to arrays of pointers	4.4, 5.2	none		
P0012R1	Make exception specifications be part of the type system	4.12, 15.4	__cpp_noexcept_function_type	201510	predefined
N4295	Folding expressions	5.1, 14.5, 14.6	__cpp_fold_expressions	201411	predefined
P0002R1	Remove Deprecated operator++(bool)	5.3	none		
N3928	Extending static_assert	7	__cpp_static_assert	201411	predefined
N3922	New Rules for auto deduction from braced-init-list	7.1	none		
P0001R1	Remove Deprecated Use of the register Keyword	7.1	none		
N4266	Attributes for namespaces and enumerators	7.2, 7.3	__cpp_namespace_attributes	201411	predefined
			__cpp_enumerator_attributes	201411	predefined
N4230	Nested namespace definition	7.3	__cpp_nested_namespace_definitions	201411	predefined
P0136R1	Rewording inheriting constructors (core issue 1941 et al)	7.3	__cpp_inheriting_constructors	201511	predefined
P0134R0	Introducing a name for brace-or-equal-initializers for non-static data members	9.2	none		
N4051	Allow typename in a template template parameter	14.1	none		
N4268	Allow constant evaluation for all non-type template arguments	14.3	__cpp_nontype_template_args	201411	predefined
N4262	Wording for Forwarding References	14.8	none		
N4285	Cleanup for exception-specification and throw-expression	15	none		
P0061R1	<code>has_include</code> for C++17	16.1	none		
N4259	Wording for <code>std::uncaught_exceptions</code>	18.8	__cpp_lib_uncaught_exceptions	201411	<exception>
P0007R1	Constant View: A proposal for a <code>std::as_const</code> helper function template	20.2	__cpp_lib_as_const	201510	<utility>
N4387	Improving pair and tuple	20.3, 20.4	none	201505	<utility> <tuple>
N4190	Removing <code>auto_ptr</code> , <code>random_shuffle()</code> , And Old <code><functional></code> Stuff	20.7-20.9	none		
P0074R0	Making <code>std::owner_less</code> more flexible	20.7	__cpp_lib_transparent_operators	201510	<memory> <functional>
N4089	Safe conversions in <code>unique_ptr<T[]></code>	20.8	none		
N4366	LWG 2228: Missing SFINAE rule in <code>unique_ptr</code> templated assignment	20.8	none		
N4169	A proposal to add <code>invoke</code> function template	20.9	__cpp_lib_invoke	201411	<functional>
N4277	TriviallyCopyable <code>reference_wrapper</code>	20.9	none		
N3911	TransformationTrait Alias <code>void_t</code>	20.10	__cpp_lib_void_t	201411	<type_traits>
N4389	Wording for <code>bool_constant</code>	20.10	__cpp_lib_bool_constant	201505	<type_traits>

P0006R0	Adopt Type Traits Variable Templates from Library Fundamentals TS for C++17	20.10	_cpp_lib_type_trait_variable_templates	201510	<type_traits>
P0013R1	Logical Operator Type Traits	20.10	_cpp_lib_logical_traits	201510	<type_traits>
P0092R1	Polishing <chrono>	20.12	_cpp_lib_chrono	201510	<chrono>
N4258	Cleaning-up noexcept in the Library	21.4, 23.3-23.5	_cpp_lib_allocator_traits_is_always_equal	201411	<memory> <scoped_allocator> <string> <deque> <forward_list> <list> <vector> <map> <set> <unordered_map> <unordered_set>
N4284	Contiguous Iterators	23.2, 24.2	<i>none</i>		
N4510	Minimal incomplete type support for standard containers	23.3	_cpp_lib_incomplete_container_elements	201505	<i>headers</i>
N4279	Improved insertion interface for unique-key maps	23.4	_cpp_lib_map_try_emplace	201411	<map>
		23.5	_cpp_lib_unordered_map_try_emplace	201411	<unordered_map>
N4280	Non-member size() and more	24.3	_cpp_lib_nonmember_container_access	201411	<iterator> <array> <deque> <forward_list> <list> <map> <regex> <set> <string> <unordered_map> <unordered_set> <vector>
N4508	A proposal to add shared_mutex (untimed)	30.4	_cpp_lib_shared_mutex	201505	<shared_mutex>
P0156R0	Variadic lock_guard	30.4	_cpp_lib_lock_guard_variadic	201510	<thread>
P0004R1	Remove Deprecated iostreams aliases	D	<i>none</i>		

[3.5] C++14 features

[1] The following table itemizes all the changes that were made to the working draft for C++14 as specified in a WG21 technical document. (Changes that were made as specified in a core or library issue are not generally included.)

[2] The table is sorted by the section of the standard primarily affected. The “Doc. No.” column links to the paper itself on the committee web site. The “Macro Name” column links to the relevant portion of the “Detailed explanation and rationale” section of this document. When the recommendation is to change the value of a macro previously recommended to be defined, the “Value” column links to the table entry for the previous recommendation.

[3] For library features, the “Header” column identifies the header that is expected to define the macro, although the macro may also be predefined. For language features, the macro must be predefined.

Significant changes to C++14

Doc. No.	Title	Primary Section	Macro Name	Value	Header
N3910	What can signal handlers do? (CWG 1441)	1.9-1.10	<i>none</i>		
N3927	Definition of Lock-Free	1.10	<i>none</i>		
N3472	Binary Literals in the C++ Core Language	2.14	_cpp_binary_literals	201304	<i>predefined</i>
			_cpp_digit_separators	201309	<i>predefined</i>
N3781	Single-Quotation-Mark as a Digit Separator	2.14	<i>none</i>		
N3323	A Proposal to Tweak Certain C++ Contextual Conversions	4	<i>none</i>		

N3648	Wording Changes for Generalized Lambda-capture	5.1	__cpp_init_captures	201304	<i>predefined</i>
N3649	Generic (Polymorphic) Lambda Expressions	5.1	__cpp_generic_lambdas	201304	<i>predefined</i>
N3664	Clarifying Memory Allocation	5.3	<i>none</i>		
N3778	C++ Sized Deallocation	5.3, 18.6	__cpp_sized_deallocation	201309	<i>predefined</i>
N3624	Core Issue 1512: Pointer comparison vs qualification conversions	5.9, 5.10	<i>none</i>		
N3652	Relaxing constraints on constexpr functions / constexpr member functions and implicit const	5.19, 7.1	__cpp_constexpr	201304	<i>predefined</i>
N3638	Return type deduction for normal functions	7.1	__cpp_decltype_auto	201304	<i>predefined</i>
			__cpp_return_type_deduction	201304	<i>predefined</i>
N3760	[[deprecated]] attribute	7.6	__has_cpp_attribute(deprecated)	201309	<i>predefined</i>
N3653	Member initializers and aggregates	8.5	__cpp_aggregate_nsdmi	201304	<i>predefined</i>
N3667	Drafting for Core 1402	12.8	<i>none</i>		
N3651	Variable Templates	14, 14.7	__cpp_variable_templates	201304	<i>predefined</i>
N3669	Fixing constexpr member functions without const	<i>various</i>	<i>none</i>		
N3673	C++ Library Working Group Ready Issues Bristol 2013	<i>various</i>	<i>none</i>		
N3658	Compile-time integer sequences	20	__cpp_lib_integer_sequence	201304	<utility>
N3668	exchange() utility function	20	__cpp_lib_exchange_function	201304	<utility>
N3471	Constexpr Library Additions: utilities	20.2-20.4	<i>none</i>		
N3670	Wording for Addressing Tuples by Type	20.2-20.4	__cpp_lib_tuples_by_type	201304	<utility>
N3887	Consistent Metafunction Aliases	20.3-20.4	__cpp_lib_tuple_element_t	201402	<utility>
N3656	make_unique	20.7	__cpp_lib_make_unique	201304	<memory>
N3421	Making Operator Functors greater<>	20.8	__cpp_lib_transparent_operators	201210	<functional>
N3545	An Incremental Improvement to integral_constant	20.9	__cpp_lib_integral_constant_callable	201304	<type_traits>
N3655	TransformationTraits Redux	20.9	__cpp_lib_transformation_trait_aliases	201304	<type_traits>
N3789	Constexpr Library Additions: functional	20.10	<i>none</i>		
N3462	std::result_of and SFINAE	20.9 20.10	__cpp_lib_result_of_sfinae	201210	<functional> <type_traits>
LWG 2112	User-defined classes that cannot be derived from	20.10	__cpp_lib_is_final	201402	<type_traits>
LWG 2247	Type traits and std::nullptr_t	20.10	__cpp_lib_is_null_pointer	201309	<type_traits>
N3469	Constexpr Library Additions: chrono	20.11	<i>none</i>		
N3642	User-defined Literals for Standard Library Types	20.11	__cpp_lib_chrono_udls	201304	<chrono>
		21.7	__cpp_lib_string_udls	201304	<string>
N3470	Constexpr Library Additions: containers	23.3	<i>none</i>		
N3657	Adding heterogeneous comparison lookup to associative containers	23.4	__cpp_lib_generic_associative_lookup	201304	<map> <set>
N3644	Null Forward Iterators	24.2	__cpp_lib_null_iterators	201304	<iterator>
LWG 2285	make_reverse_iterator	24.5	__cpp_lib_make_reverse_iterator	201402	<iterator>
N3671	Making non-modifying sequence operations more robust	25.2	__cpp_lib_robust_nonmodifying_seq_ops	201304	<algorithm>
N3779	User-defined Literals for std::complex	26.4	__cpp_lib_complex_udls	201309	<complex>
N3924	Discouraging rand() in C++14	26.8	<i>none</i>		
N3654	Quoted Strings Library Proposal	27.7	__cpp_lib_quoted_string_io	201304	<iomanip>
LWG					

N2249	Remove gets from <stdio>	27.9	none		
N3786	Prohibiting "out of thin air" results in C++14	29.3	none		
N3659	Shared locking in C++	30.4	__has_include(<shared_mutex>)	1	<i>predefined</i>
N3891	A proposal to rename shared_mutex to shared_timed_mutex	30.4	__cpp_lib_shared_timed_mutex	201402	<shared_mutex>
N3776	Wording for ~future	30.6	none		

[3.6] C++11 features

Significant features of C++11

Doc. No.	Title	Primary Section	Macro name	Value	Header
N2249	New Character Types in C++	2.13	<code>__cpp_unicode_characters</code>	200704	<i>predefined</i>
N2442	Raw and Unicode String Literals Unified Proposal	2.13	<code>__cpp_raw_strings</code>	200710	<i>predefined</i>
			<code>__cpp_unicode_literals</code>	200710	<i>predefined</i>
N2765	User-defined Literals	2.13, 13.5	<code>__cpp_user_defined_literals</code>	200809	<i>predefined</i>
N2927	New wording for C++0x lambdas	5.1	<code>__cpp_lambdas</code>	200907	<i>predefined</i>
N2235	Generalized Constant Expressions	5.19, 7.1	<code>__cpp_constexpr</code>	200704	<i>predefined</i>
N2930	Range-Based For Loop Wording (Without Concepts)	6.5	<code>__cpp_range_based_for</code>	200907	<i>predefined</i>
N1720	Proposal to Add Static Assertions to the Core Language	7	<code>__cpp_static_assert</code>	200410	<i>predefined</i>
N2343	Decltype	7.1	<code>__cpp_decltype</code>	200707	<i>predefined</i>
N2761	Towards support for attributes in C++	7.6	<code>__cpp_attributes</code>	200809	<i>predefined</i>
			<code>__has_cpp_attribute(noreturn)</code>	200809	<i>predefined</i>
			<code>__has_cpp_attribute(carries_dependency)</code>	200809	<i>predefined</i>
N2118	A Proposal to Add an Rvalue Reference to the C++ Language	8.3	<code>__cpp_rvalue_references</code>	200610	<i>predefined</i>
N2242	Proposed Wording for Variadic Templates	8.3, 14	<code>__cpp_variadic_templates</code>	200704	<i>predefined</i>
N2672	Initializer List proposed wording	8.5	<code>__cpp_initializer_lists</code>	200806	<i>predefined</i>
N1986	Delegating Constructors	12.6	<code>__cpp_delegating_constructors</code>	200604	<i>predefined</i>
N2756	Non-static data member initializers	12.6	<code>__cpp_nsdmi</code>	200809	<i>predefined</i>
N2540	Inheriting Constructors	12.9	<code>__cpp_inheriting_constructors</code>	200802	<i>predefined</i>
N2439	Extending move semantics to *this	13.3	<code>__cpp_ref_qualifiers</code>	200710	<i>predefined</i>
N2258	Template Aliases	14.5	<code>__cpp_alias_templates</code>	200704	<i>predefined</i>

[3.7] Conditionally-supported constructs

[1] STUB

[3.8] C++98 features

[1] STUB: especially for exception handling and RTTI

Feature	Primary section	Macro name	Value	Header
Run-time type identification	5.2	<code>__cpp_rtti</code>	199711	<i>predefined</i>
Exception handling	15	<code>__cpp_exceptions</code>	199711	<i>predefined</i>

[3.9] Features published and later removed

[3.9.1] Features removed from C++14

Features in the first CD of C++14, subsequently removed to a Technical Specification

Doc.	Title	Primary	Macro Name	Value	Header
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No.		Section			
N3639	Runtime-sized arrays with automatic storage duration	8.3	__cpp_runtime_arrays	201304	<i>predefined</i>
N3672	A proposal to add a utility class to represent optional objects	20.5	__has_include(<optional>)	1	<i>predefined</i>
N3662	C++ Dynamic Arrays	23.2, 23.3	__has_include(<dynarray>)	1	<i>predefined</i>

[1] The intention is that an implementation which provides runtime-sized arrays as specified in the first CD should define `__cpp_runtime_arrays` as 201304. The expectation is that a later document specifying runtime-sized arrays will specify a different value for `__cpp_runtime_arrays`.

[4] Recommendations from Technical Specifications

In this section, feature-test macros from all WG21 Technical Specifications are collected, for convenience.

[4.1] C++ Extensions for Library Fundamentals

The recommended macro name is " `__cpp_lib_experimental` " followed by the string in the "Macro Name Suffix" column.

Doc. No.	Title	Primary Section	Macro Name Suffix	Value	Header
N3915	<code>apply()</code> call a function with arguments from a tuple	3.2.2	<code>apply</code>	201402	<code><experimental/tuple></code>
N3932	Variable Templates For Type Traits	3.3.1	<code>type_trait_variable_templates</code>	201402	<code><experimental/type_traits></code>
N3866	Invocation type traits	3.3.2	<code>invocation_type</code>	201406	<code><experimental/type_traits></code>
N3916	Type-erased allocator for <code>std::function</code>	4.2	<code>function_erased_allocator</code>	201406	<code><experimental/functional></code>
N3905	Extending <code>std::search</code> to use Additional Searching Algorithms	4.3	<code>boyer_moore_searching</code>	201411	<code><experimental/functional></code>
N3672, N3793	A utility class to represent optional objects	5	<code>optional</code>	201411	<code><experimental/optional></code>
N3804	Any Library Proposal	6	<code>any</code>	201411	<code><experimental/any></code>
N3921	<code>string_view</code> : a non-owning reference to a string	7	<code>string_view</code>	201411	<code><experimental/string_view></code>
N3920	Extending <code>shared_ptr</code> to Support Arrays	8.2	<code>shared_ptr_arrays</code>	201406	<code><experimental/memory></code>
N3916	Polymorphic Memory Resources	8.4	<code>memory_resources</code>	201402	<code><experimental/memory_resource></code>
N3916	Type-erased allocator for <code>std::promise</code>	9.2	<code>promise_erased_allocator</code>	201406	<code><experimental/future></code>
N3916	Type-erased allocator for <code>std::packaged_task</code>	9.3	<code>packaged_task_erased_allocator</code>	201406	<code><experimental/future></code>
N3925	A sample Proposal	10.3	<code>sample</code>	201402	<code><experimental/algorithm></code>

[4.2] C++ Extensions for Parallelism

Name	Value	Header
<code>__cpp_lib_experimental_parallel_algorithm</code>	201505	<code><experimental/algorithm></code> <code><experimental/exception_list></code> <code><experimental/execution_policy></code> <code><experimental/numeric></code>

[4.3] File System Technical Specification

Name	Value	Header
<code>__cpp_lib_experimental_filesystem</code>	201406	<code><experimental/filesystem></code>

[4.4] C++ Extensions for Transactional Memory

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Name	Value	Header
__cpp_transactional_memory	201505	predeclared

[5] Detailed explanation and rationale

[5.1] C++14 features

[1] Many of the examples here have been shamelessly and almost brainlessly plagiarized from the cited paper. Assistance with improving examples is solicited.

[5.1.1] N3323: A Proposal to Tweak Certain C++ Contextual Conversions

[1] This paper specifies a small change that is considered to be more of a bug fix than a new feature, so no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.2] N3421: Making Operator Functors greater<>

[1] Example:

```
#if __cpp_lib_transparent_operators
    sort(v.begin(), v.end(), greater<>());
#else
    sort(v.begin(), v.end(), greater<valueType>());
#endif
```

[5.1.3] N3462: std::result_of and SFINAE

[1] The macro __cpp_lib_result_of_sfinae was originally erroneously recommended to be defined in the unrelated header <functional>. This error is being corrected, because it is believed that no implementation actually followed the erroneous recommendation.

[2] Example:

```
template<typename A>
#if __cpp_lib_result_of_sfinae
    typename std::result_of<inc(A)>::type
#else
    decltype(std::declval<inc>()(std::declval<A>()))
#endif
try_inc(A a);
```

[5.1.4] N3469: Constexpr Library Additions: chrono N3470: Constexpr Library Additions: containers N3471: Constexpr Library Additions: utilities

[1] These papers just add constexpr to the declarations of several dozen library functions in various headers. It is not clear that a macro to test for the presence of these changes would be sufficiently useful to be worthwhile.

[5.1.5] N3472: Binary Literals in the C++ Core Language

[1] Example:

```
int const packed_zero_to_three =
#if __cpp_binary_literals
    0b00011011;
#else
    0x1B;
#endif
```

[5.1.6] N3545: An Incremental Improvement to integral_constant

[1] Example:

```
constexpr bool arithmetic =
#if __cpp_lib_integral_constant_callable
    std::is_arithmetic<T>{}();
#else
    static_cast<bool>(std::is_arithmetic<T>{});
```

```
#endif
```

[5.1.7] N3624: Core Issue 1512: Pointer comparison vs qualification conversions

[1] This paper contained the wording changes to resolve a core issue. It did not introduce a new feature, so no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.8] N3638: Return type deduction for normal functions

[1] This paper describes two separate features: the ability to deduce the return type of a function from the return statements contained in its body, and the ability to use `decltype(auto)`. These features can be implemented independently, so a macro is recommended for each.

[2] Examples:

```
template<typename T>
auto abs(T x)
#ifdef __cpp_return_type_deduction
    -> decltype(x < 0 ? -x : x)
#endif
{
    return x < 0 ? -x : x;
}
```

[5.1.9] N3639: Runtime-sized arrays with automatic storage duration

[1] This was removed from C++14 to TS 19569.

[2] Example:

```
#if __cpp_runtime_arrays
    T local_buffer[n];        // more efficient than vector
#else
    std::vector<T> local_buffer(n);
#endif
```

[5.1.10] N3642: User-defined Literals for Standard Library Types

[1] This paper specifies user-defined literal operators for two different standard library types, which could be implemented independently. Furthermore, user-defined literal operators are expected to be added later for at least one other library type. So for consistency and flexibility, each type is given its own macro.

[2] Examples:

[5.1.11] N3644: Null Forward Iterators

[1] Example:

[5.1.12] N3648: Wording Changes for Generalized Lambda-capture

[1] Example:

[5.1.13] N3649: Generic (Polymorphic) Lambda Expressions

[1] Example:

[5.1.14] N3651: Variable Templates

[1] Example:

[5.1.15] N3652: Relaxing constraints on constexpr functions / constexpr member functions and implicit const

[1] The major change proposed by this paper is considered to be strictly a further development of the `constexpr` feature of C++11. Consequently, the recommendation here is to give an increased value to the macro indicating C++11 support for `constexpr`.

[2] Example:

[5.1.16] N3653: Member initializers and aggregates

[1] Example:

[5.1.17] N3654: Quoted Strings Library Proposal

[1] Example:

[5.1.18] N3655: TransformationTraits Redux

[1] Example:

[5.1.19] N3656: make_unique

[1] Example:

[5.1.20] N3657: Adding heterogeneous comparison lookup to associative containers

[1] Example:

[5.1.21] N3658: Compile-time integer sequences

[1] Example:

[5.1.22] N3659: Shared locking in C++

[1] The original recommendation, of a macro defined in header `<mutex>`, was not useful, and has been retracted.

[2] For new headers, we have a long-term solution that uses `__has_include`. There was not sufficient support and a number of objections against adding macros to existing library header files, as there was not consensus on a place to put them.

[3] There is also a simple workaround for users that are not using libraries that define the header file: supplying their own header that is further down the search path than the library headers.

[4] Example:

```
#if __has_include(<shared_mutex>)  
#include <shared_mutex>
```

```
// code that uses std::shared_mutex  
#endif
```

[5.1.23] N3662: C++ Dynamic Arrays

[1] This was removed from C++14 to TS 19569.

[2] Example:

[5.1.24] N3664: Clarifying Memory Allocation

[1] The substantive change in this paper just relaxes a restriction on implementations. There is no new feature for a programmer to use, so no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.25] N3667: Drafting for Core 1402

[1] This paper contained the wording changes to resolve a core issue. It did not introduce a new feature, so no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.26] N3668: exchange() utility function

[1] Example:

[5.1.27] N3669: Fixing constexpr member functions without const

[1] This paper contained the wording changes to ensure that a minor change proposed by N3652 did not impact the standard library. It did not introduce a new feature, so no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.28] N3670: Wording for Addressing Tuples by Type

[1] Example:

[5.1.29] N3671: Making non-modifying sequence operations more robust

[1] Example:

[5.1.30] N3672: A proposal to add a utility class to represent optional objects

[1] This was removed from C++14 to TS 19568.

[2] See [N3659](#) for rationale.

[3] Example:

```
#if __has_include(<optional>)
#include <optional>

// code that uses std::optional
#endif
```

[5.1.31] N3673: C++ Library Working Group Ready Issues Bristol 2013

[1] This paper was just a collection of library issues. It did not introduce a new feature, so no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.32] N3760: `[[deprecated]]` attribute

[1] Differentiating attribute availability based on compiler-specific macros is error-prone. Since vendors are allowed to provide implementation-specific attributes in addition to standards-based attributes, this feature provides a uniform, future-proof way to test the availability of attributes.

[2] Example:

```
#ifdef __has_cpp_attribute
# if __has_cpp_attribute(deprecated)
#   define ATTR_DEPRECATED(msg) [[deprecated(msg)]]
# else
#   define ATTR_DEPRECATED(msg)
# endif
#endif
```

```
ATTR_DEPRECATED("f() has been deprecated") void f();
```

[5.1.33] N3776: Wording for `~future`

[1] The change made by this paper is a bug fix, and no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.34] N3778: C++ Sized Deallocation

[1] Example:

[5.1.35] N3779: User-defined Literals for `std::complex`

[1] Example:

[5.1.36] N3781: Single-Quotation-Mark as a Digit Separator

[1] Writing code that uses digit separators conditionally when they are available would require:

- either duplicating constants, presumably containing large numbers of digits, which would be error-prone and difficult to maintain,
- or using a scheme based on macros and token concatenation, which would effectively take the place of digit separators as supported by the language.

[2] Thus it is believed that a macro indicating support for digit separators in the language would not be sufficiently useful.

[5.1.37] N3786: Prohibiting "out of thin air" results in C++14

[1] The change made by this paper is a bug fix, and no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.38] N3789: Constexpr Library Additions: functional

[1] See [N3471](#) for rationale.

[5.1.39] N3887: Consistent Metafunction Aliases

[1] Example:

[5.1.40] N3891: A proposal to rename `shared_mutex` to `shared_timed_mutex`

[1] Example:

[5.1.41] N3910: What can signal handlers do? (CWG 1441)

[1] The change made by this paper is a bug fix, and no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.42] N3924: Discouraging `rand()` in C++14

[1] The change made by this paper is not normative; no macro is necessary.

[5.1.43] N3927: Definition of Lock-Free

[1] The change made by this paper is a bug fix, and no macro is considered necessary.

[5.1.44] LWG issue 2112: User-defined classes that cannot be derived from

[1] Libraries that want to do empty-base optimization could reasonably want to use `!is_final && is_empty` if `is_final` exists, and fall back to just using `is_empty` otherwise.

[2] Example:

```
template<typename T>
struct use_empty_base_opt :
    std::integral_constant<bool,
        std::is_empty<T>::value
    >
{
    #if __cpp_lib_has_is_final
        && !std::is_final<T>::value
    #endif
};
```

[5.1.45] LWG issue 2247: Type traits and `std::nullptr_t`

[1] Example:

[5.1.46] LWG issue 2249: Remove `gets` from `<cstdio>`

[1] Since portable, well-written code does not use the `gets` function at all, there is no need for a macro to indicate whether it is available.

[5.1.47] LWG issue 2285: `make_reverse_iterator`

[1] Example:

[5.2] C++17 features

[5.2.1] N3911: TransformationTrait Alias `void_t`

Example:

```
#if __cpp_lib_void_t
    using std::void_t;
#else
    template< class... > using void_t = void;
#endif
```

[5.2.2] N3922: New Rules for auto deduction from braced-init-list

This change is considered a fix to a problem in C++14, not a new feature, so no macro is recommended. Code that needs to work both with and without this change should not attempt to deduce a type from a direct *braced-init-list* initializer.

[5.2.3] N3928: Extending static_assert

Example:

```
#if __cpp_static_assert
#if __cpp_static_assert > 201400
#define Static_Assert(cond) static_assert(cond)
#else
#define Static_Assert(cond) static_assert(cond, #cond)
#endif
#define Static_Assert_Msg(cond, msg) static_assert(cond, msg)
#else
#define Static_Assert(cond)
#define Static_Assert_Msg(cond, msg)
#endif
```

[5.2.4] N4051: Allow typename in a template template parameter

This is a minor stylistic extension; there is no difference in functionality or verbosity between code that uses the `class` keyword and code that uses the `typename` keyword in this context. If portability is needed between implementations having and lacking this feature, generally it would be easier to continue to write code using `class` than to write and maintain conditional compilation to use `typename` when available. So a macro for this feature would not seem to be justified.

[5.2.5] N4086: Removing trigraphs??!

This is a very low-level change, purely lexical. Writing code to use trigraphs when they are available and different characters when trigraphs are not available would be tedious, and the resulting code would be even uglier than code that just uses trigraphs.

Even in circumstances where use of a character not in the ISO/IEC 646 Basic Character Set is problematic, it would generally be easier to use alternative tokens (a.k.a. “digraphs”) than to conditionally use trigraphs.

[5.2.6] N4089: Safe conversions in unique_ptr<T[]>

This is considered a fix for a library issue, to remove an unnecessary restriction; no macro is considered necessary.

[5.2.7] N4169: A proposal to add invoke function template

Example:

```
template<typename F>
auto deref_fn(F&& f)
{
    return [f](auto&&... args) {
#if __cpp_lib_invoke
        return *std::invoke(f, std::forward<decltype(args)>(args)...);
#else
        return *f(std::forward<decltype(args)>(args)...);
#endif
    };
}
```

In this example, member function pointers are supported only if `invoke` is available.

[5.2.8] N4190: Removing auto_ptr, random_shuffle(), And Old <functional> Stuff

These library features are removed because superior alternatives to them were introduced in C++11. Because these alternatives are superior, there is little motivation to maintain code that uses one of these obsolescent features when available.

[5.2.9] N4230: Nested namespace definition

This feature doesn't provide any new functionality; it just makes it somewhat easier to write code. For code that needs to be portable to an implementation that doesn't provide this feature, it would be easier just to avoid using the feature than it would be maintain the code to use it when available but not otherwise. Therefore, a macro to indicate the availability of this feature

would not seem to be justified.

[5.2.10] N4258: Cleaning-up noexcept in the Library

Example:

```
template <class T, class Allocator = std::allocator<T>>
class myContainer {
    typedef std::allocator_traits<Allocator> alloc_traits;
public:
    ...
    myContainer& operator=(myContainer&& x)
#ifdef __cpp_lib_allocator_traits_is_always_equal
    noexcept(alloc_traits::propagate_on_container_move_assignment::value ||
             alloc_traits::is_always_equal::value);
#else
    noexcept(alloc_traits::propagate_on_container_move_assignment::value);
#endif
    ...
};
```

Without the trait, the code will be correct, but container move-assignment would have fewer exception guarantees, especially with pre-C++11 stateless allocators. An implementation of a mutating algorithm might choose to use copy-assignment instead of move-assignment if the `noexcept` clause evaluates to false, because the implementation is unable to determine whether the allocator always compares equal.

[5.2.11] N4259: Wording for std::uncaught_exceptions

Example:

```
bool throw_may_terminate()
{
    if __cpp_lib_uncaught_exceptions
        return std::uncaught_exceptions() > 0;
    #else
        return std::uncaught_exception();
    #endif
}
```

[5.2.12] N4261: Proposed resolution for Core Issue 330: Qualification conversions and pointers to arrays of pointers

This paper fixes a core language issue; no new feature is introduced.

[5.2.13] N4262: Wording for Forwarding References

The changes detailed in this paper are solely editorial. It does not introduce any new feature.

[5.2.14] N4266: Attributes for namespaces and enumerators

Example:

```
enum {
    old_val
#ifdef __cpp_enumerator_attributes
    [[deprecated]]
#endif
    , new_val };
```

[5.2.15] N4267: Adding u8 character literals

This feature gives guaranteed access to the Unicode encoding for a 7-bit ASCII character even in an implementation that uses a different character encoding. In an application that needs this functionality, it would probably be easier simply to hard-code the numeric values of the needed encodings. Thus a macro for this feature would seem to be of limited usefulness.

[5.2.16] N4268: Allow constant evaluation for all non-type template arguments

Example:

```
int n = 0, m = 0;
int &r = n;
template<int &> struct X {};
```

```
#if __cpp_nontype_template_args
    X<r> x;
#else
    std::conditional<&r == &n, X<n>, X<m>>::type x;
#endif
```

[5.2.17] N4277: TriviallyCopyable reference wrapper

This paper imposes a new requirement on implementations, which most implementations had already satisfied. A reliable indication of when this requirement was not satisfied would have been useful for programming; an indication that it is satisfied would not be so useful.

[5.2.18] N4279: Improved insertion interface for unique-key maps

Example:

```
#if __cpp_lib_try_emplace
    m.insert_or_assign("foo", std::move(p));
#else
    m["foo"] = std::move(p);
#endif
```

In this example, if `insert_or_assign` is not available, the type of `p` must be default-constructible.

[5.2.19] N4280: Non-member size() and more

Example:

```
auto n =
#if __cpp_lib_nonmember_container_access
    std::size(c);
#else
    c.size();
#endif
```

In this example, an array type is supported for `c` only if the nonmember `size` function is available.

[5.2.20] N4284: Contiguous Iterators

The changes detailed in this paper are solely editorial. It does not introduce any new feature.

[5.2.21] N4285: Cleanup for exception-specification and throw-expression

The changes detailed in this paper are solely editorial. It does not introduce any new feature.

[5.2.22] N4295: Folding expressions

Example:

```
#if __cpp_fold_expressions
template<typename... T>
    auto sum(T... args) { return (args + ...); }
#else
auto sum() { return 0; }
template<typename T>
    auto sum(T t) { return t; }
template<typename T, typename... Ts>
    auto sum(T t, Ts... ts) { return t + sum(ts...); }
#endif
```

[5.2.23] N4366: LWG 2228 missing SFINAE rule

This change fixes a defect in the library. No new feature is added, so no feature-test macro is needed.

[5.2.24] N4387: Improving pair and tuple

Lenexa

[5.2.25] N4389: Wording for bool_constant

Example:

```
#if __cpp_lib_bool_constant
    template <bool B>
    using my_bool_constant = std::bool_constant<B>;
#else
    template <bool B>
    using my_bool_constant = std::integral_constant<bool, B>;
#endif
```

[5.2.26] N4508: A proposal to add shared mutex (untimed)

Example:

Lenexa

[5.2.27] N4510: Minimal incomplete type support for standard containers

Lenexa

[5.2.28] P0001R1: Remove Deprecated Use of the register Keyword

The simplest way to write code to be portable between implementations that have and lack this change is to avoid using the register keyword. A feature-test macro would not be sufficiently useful.

[5.2.29] P0002R1: Remove Deprecated operator++(bool)

The simplest way to write code to be portable between implementations that have and lack this change is to avoid applying ++ to bool objects. A feature-test macro would not be sufficiently useful.

[5.2.30] P0004R1: Remove Deprecated iostreams aliases

The simplest way to write code to be portable between implementations that have and lack this change is not to use the previously deprecated features. A feature-test macro would not be sufficiently useful.

[5.2.31] P0006R0: Adopt Type Traits Variable Templates from Library Fundamentals TS for C++17

Example:

Kona

Example:

[5.2.32] P0007R1: Constant View: A proposal for a std::as_const helper function template

Example:

Kona

[5.2.33] P0012R1: Make exception specifications be part of the type system

Example:

Kona

[5.2.34] P0013R1: Logical Operator Type Traits

Example:

Kona

[5.2.35] P0061R1: __has_include for C++17

Because it operates like a macro, and can be tested for as such, __has_include can operate as its own feature-test macro; no other macro is needed.

[5.2.36] P0074R0: Making std::owner_less more flexible

[5.2.37] P0092R1: Polishing <chrono>

[5.2.38] P0134R0: Introducing a name for brace-or-equal-initializers for non-static data members

This change is entirely editorial; no feature is added, and no test macro is needed.

[5.2.39] P0136R1: Rewording inheriting constructors (core issue 1941 et al)

This change is considered a minor tweak to the inheriting constructors feature, and mostly just fixes issues with the original description. However, it can change the behavior of some code. Therefore the value of the `__cpp_inheriting_constructors` macro is adjusted.

Example:

[5.2.40] P0156R1: Variadic lock_guard

Example:

[6] Annex: Model wording for a Technical Specification

[1] It is recommended that Technical Specifications include the wording below. *yyymm* indicates the year and month of the date of the TS.

1.x Feature testing [intro.features]

An implementation that provides support for this Technical Specification shall define the feature test macro(s) in Table X.

Table X — Feature Test Macro(s)

Name	Value	Header
<code>__cpp_name</code>	<i>yyymm</i>	<i>“predefined”</i> OR <i>“<name>”</i>

[7] Revision history

Date	Document	Description
2016-02-23	P0096R2	Fixed recommendation for P0074R0 A few editorial fixes
2016-01-19	P0096R1	Added C++17 features from Kona
2015-09-16	P0096R0	Added C++17 features from Lenexa A few adjustments to C++17 recommendations Added model wording for a Technical Specification Added summaries of recommendations from TS'es
2015-04-09	N4440	Added C++17 features from Urbana A couple of changes to C++14 recommendations A few new C++11 features
2014-12-29	SD-6	Updated from N4200
2014-10-08	N4200	Updated for final C++14 Added more support for C++11 and C++98
2014-05-22	N4030	Updated for changes from Chicago and Issaquah meetings Added <code>__has_cpp_attribute</code> test
2013-11-27	SD-6	Initial publication No substantive changes from N3745

2013-08-28	N3745	Endorsed by WG21 membership
2013-06-27	N3694	Initial draft